Digital Social Work Practice practice worksheet

SWP-031 | Version 1.1.0 | SWEEP Academy

Apply all three lessons to the fictional case below. Do not use identifiable service-user information. Write a reasoned plan that makes uncertainty and decision authority explicit.

Use the laws, professional scope, organisational policies and approved referral routes that apply to your setting. This course is educational and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical or legal procedures. All worked cases are fictional. Research notes distinguish published findings from SWEEP teaching examples.

Practice case

A neighbourhood advice service wants to replace its walk-in queue with a web booking system. Some residents use library computers, some need audio instructions, and others work shifts. Staff want to use automated summaries to reduce paperwork. Design a service pathway that preserves access, privacy and accountable decisions.

Activity 1

Draw two booking routes for the service. Identify one barrier at each step and propose a way to test it without using identifiable case material.

Write your response here

Activity 2

Write a five-field information register for booking. For each field give the purpose and authorised audience; mark any retention or legal question for local review.

Write your response here

Activity 3

Write a verification checklist for an automated appointment summary, and a fallback plan for an unsuitable or disconnected remote appointment.

Write your response here

Self assessment and facilitator discussion

For each activity, use 0 for missing reasoning, 1 for a partly justified response and 2 for a justified response with relevant safeguards and limits. This is a formative rubric, not the platform's certification score.

Activity 1 criteria

A strong response preserves resident choice, tests actual tasks, gives the assisted route a comparable opportunity, and names both a completion measure and a feedback method.

Activity 2 criteria

Necessary booking information is separated from casework records. The answer states who must resolve uncertain rules and explains recipient checks and the incident-reporting route.

Activity 3 criteria

The checklist verifies statements against sources, checks omissions, protects case information, identifies a responsible human and defines a safe local fallback.

Next learning step

Identify one assumption you changed and one procedure you must verify locally. Explain who can resolve it before you apply the plan in practice.

Sources and evidence limits

[R1] Kvakic, M., and Larsson, K. K. (2024). Caseworkers on the digital streets: Discretion in the digital decision-making process. Journal of Comparative Social Work, 19(1), 13-40. https://doi.org/10.31265/jcsw.v19i1.624

[S1] NASW and ASWB. Standards for Technology in Social Work Practice. https://www.socialworkers.org/Practice/NASW-Practice-Standards-Guidelines/Standards-for-Technology-in-Social-Work-Practice

[S4] IFSW (2018). Global Social Work Statement of Ethical Principles. https://www.ifsw.org/global-social-work-statement-of-ethical-principles/

The index record is a discovery aid, not a guarantee of quality. Read the source before applying its findings to a different setting. No article endorses this course.